The Book That Would Not Stay

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 4, Episode 9

The round support rolled beneath Moon. Nib tried holding the book with his nose, then discovered he could not turn a page. Lark lowered it onto the flat landing mat. The fitting diagram showed a wooden foot for the rest, waiting in the boat's small parts tray.

“A good book needs a good place to be a book,” Nib observed solemnly. “This one has one now,” Lark replied warmly.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **moon**

“Oo has a different sound in book, look, and foot,” Lark modeled clearly. “Compare book with moon. We'll learn and practice each whole example rather than assuming one oo sound fits every word. Read foot on the fitting sketch after listening.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try book, look, foot. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read foot,” Lark invited gently. “Which broad part belongs under the unstable rest?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The book is on the rest. Its foot is on the mat.**

“What supports the book rest in our little passage?” Lark asked gently. “Look back at the second sentence.”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib fitted the broad foot against the rest's base. The angled surface stayed still. Lark placed Moon on it and opened a page without needing anyone's nose. The Reed Creek borrower received the book, and Lark entered the second loan once. Train and Phone remained aboard for Farm Quay and Mill Pond.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write book beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Moon stayed with its borrower for the agreed time. Your boat left Reed Creek with two loans completed. At the next bend, a mooring line had wandered into the cart's route across the deck.